

Chapter 177-8

Gu Yixue had just finished one cigarette. She glanced at the screen that had returned to the home page, turned off her phone, tossed it aside, then took another deep drag on the cigarette. Only when the cigarette butt was about to burn her hand did she pull back, stubbing it out on the table before throwing it into the trash can. She buried herself wearily in the large chair.

After a while, the more she thought about it, the more irritated she became. She reached for the cigarettes on the table again, but just as she pulled one out, a hand pressed down on hers, stopping her from taking the cigarette.

A familiar warmth came from the back of her hand. Gu Yixue's movements froze. She slowly turned her head to look and saw Shen Fenghe standing there in a suit, backlit like a deity.

Gu Yixue was momentarily dazed.

Shen Fenghe stuffed the cigarette back into the pack, then tossed the pack aside. She loosened her tie and threw the constraining tie onto the large bed behind her, asking coldly: "Short on money?"

Only then did Gu Yixue come back to her senses. Her expression was languid, carrying a hint of grievance: "When did you get back?"

But Shen Fenghe grabbed her wrist. "I'm asking you."

"I'm also asking you." Gu Yixue stood up, very close to her.

She wasn't as tall as Shen Fenghe, so she tilted her head up slightly to look at her.

"When you were smoking your first cigarette." Shen Fenghe said.

Gu Yixue lightly pressed her lips together. The edges of her red lips were slightly smudged, the lip line blurred, her tone helpless: "Fine, you saw everything."

"When did you learn these things?" Shen Fenghe asked.

Gu Yixue leaned in closer, very close to her. "When you weren't paying attention."

"Are you short on money?" Shen Fenghe asked again.

"You heard everything and you're still asking me?" Gu Yixue smiled at her alluringly, raising an eyebrow: "Jiejie¹, shouldn't you just throw money at me directly?"

"You're not short on money." Shen Fenghe said. "You have seven hundred million in your account."

Gu Yixue: "..."

She secretly gritted her teeth. "Just because I'm not short on money, you can't give me some?"

Shen Fenghe remained unmoved, but her throat moved slightly.

"Wife." Gu Yixue's eyes reddened again. Her fingers played with the collar of Shen Fenghe's shirt, undoing the topmost button to reveal her beautiful collarbones. She called out in a charming and tender voice: "Jiejie."

But Shen Fenghe gripped her hand, calling her name with a dangerous tone, enunciating each word: "Gu. Yi. Xue."

Gu Yixue had heard this dangerous tone from her many times and didn't mind it. She was even vaguely expectant: "Hmm?"

"Stop messing around." Shen Fenghe said.

Gu Yixue leaned in and kissed her chin: "Did you drink?"

"Had a business dinner tonight." Shen Fenghe raised her arm and hugged her briefly. Her arm happened to cover the exposed waistline, the hem of her shirt sleeve overlapping with Gu Yixue's pants. "You smell like smoke."

Gu Yixue laughed softly: "You reek of smoke and alcohol yourself. How can you still smell the smoke in my mouth?"

Shen Fenghe held her and lifted her up slightly, the two of them drawing even closer. "Smoke less in the future."

"Are you worried about me?" Gu Yixue pushed her luck.

Shen Fenghe frowned slightly. "It's too pungent."

Gu Yixue pressed her lips together and withdrew from her embrace. "Forget it then."

She then returned to the chair, curling up in it again with a languid posture.

Shen Fenghe, whose arms were suddenly empty, felt momentarily out of sorts, not knowing what she should do. She also felt a chill.

She stared at Gu Yixue's profile for a while, then went straight to the bathroom to wash up, leaving Gu Yixue alone.

Only after hearing the sounds did Gu Yixue open her eyes. Looking at the myriad of lights as bright as day, she sighed at how narrow this city really was.

Always showing her these warm moments.

Moments she could never possess no matter what.

Yet also moments she dreamed of.

Gu Yixue reached for the cigarettes, only to find that Shen Fenghe had thrown them somewhere unknown.

How irritating.

So she kept clicking the lighter on and off.

The clicking sound echoed continuously in the quiet space.

After playing with it for a while, Gu Yixue curled up on the sofa and opened her phone to watch a movie—an old film she had seen many times.

She really liked the actress in it, who had passed away at the height of her fame and glory.

As that familiar voice played, she unknowingly fell asleep curled up on the sofa.

When Shen Fenghe came out, this was the scene she saw.

The girl was curled up on the sofa, phone resting on her lap, the movie still playing on the phone. The female lead's voice came through the speaker, saying: "If you say that, it means you don't love me~ I'm already crying and you still won't come hug me."

Not knowing what she was dreaming about, Gu Yixue's brows were slightly furrowed, and tears traced down from the corners of her eyes.

The Gu Yixue everyone usually saw was very strong. She could methodically organize an entire production crew, could nonchalantly fight with platforms.

She had the most fearless personality.

Shen Fenghe had always thought Gu Yixue was very well-behaved, just a bit quietly mischievous.

Growing up in that kind of environment from a young age, bullied by Gu Chunmian² time and time again—locked in closets, buried in sand piles, thrown into the sea—escaping death over and over.

She knew why Gu Yixue depended on her.

Because when Gu Chunmian bullied her, it was Shen Fenghe who appeared and saved her.

After it happened many times, she always felt this older sister was amazing.

But it was just a simple admiration.

This was probably just hero worship, not really love.

But Shen Fenghe wasn't expecting love either.

This kind of marriage was enough.

For her, that's how it was.

Footnotes:

¹ Jiejie (姐姐) - Literally means "older sister" in Chinese. It's commonly used as an affectionate term for an older woman, especially in romantic contexts. Here, Gu Yixue uses it flirtatiously with her wife Shen Fenghe.

² Gu Chunmian - A character who appears to be related to Gu Yixue (likely a sibling or cousin from the same family) who bullied her severely during childhood.